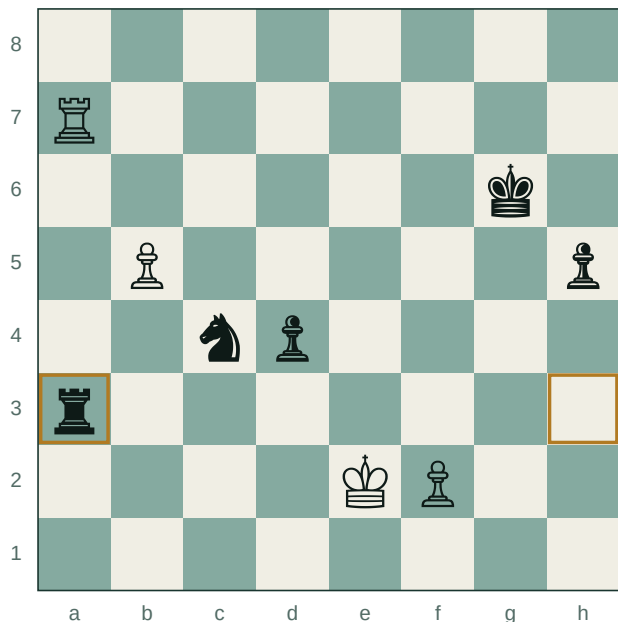


Promotion combinations: White, move 37

Promotion combinations

White to move



Previous move: 36...Rxa3. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

37. Rxa3 Nxa3 38. b6 Nc4 39. b7 Ne5 40. b8=Q

37.Rxa3 The rook captures the rook on a3. Recorded reply: **37...Nxa3**.

38.b6 The pawn moves from b5 to b6. Recorded reply: **38...Nc4**.

39.b7 The pawn moves from b6 to b7. Recorded reply: **39...Ne5**.

40.b8=Q The pawn moves from b7 to b8. The pawn becomes a queen.

At the end, nominal material is White 10 / Black 5 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +8. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +8:** the balance goes from -3 to +5. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Always inspect stalemate and underpromotion resources. A queen is usually strongest, but the exact position determines the choice.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

An advanced pawn can turn a tactical sequence into a new queen or another useful piece. Promotion may occur with capture or check, and the choice of piece can change the outcome.

HOW TO LOOK

Calculate the pawn's route, the safety of the promotion square, and whether the new piece can survive or give a decisive check.

The defending king is on g6. Geometrically undefended: knight on c4. Check for tactical protection.